Earthquake Preparedness and Response Policy

1. Purpose and Commitment

FRAM School is dedicated to safeguarding all members of its community, including young children, students, staff, and visitors. Recognizing the diverse age groups on campus: from early childhood to secondary levels, this policy establishes age-appropriate, clear procedures for earthquake safety, emphasizing practical drills and ongoing education tailored to each group's understanding.

2. Core Principles and Responsibilities

The Earthquake Response Policy is developed by the School's Health & Safety Committee, approved by the SLT, and reviewed annually.

The Health & Safety Officer, in collaboration with school leadership, updates procedures in line with national legislation and safety best practices.

The school maintains strong links with emergency services and local authorities to stay current on safety protocols.

All staff members, including teachers, support staff, and administration, are responsible for implementing and reinforcing these procedures.

The Head of School ensures routine risk assessments across all learning environments, including specialized areas like science labs and tech rooms.

Designated Fire and Evacuation Wardens are assigned for each building and area, with their roles and contact details displayed publicly.

The Campus Manager ensures evacuation routes, signage, and safety equipment are consistently maintained and accessible.

3. Tailored Measures for All Age Groups

Because students range from 5 years old to secondary levels, safety measures, instructions, and drills are adapted accordingly:

Early Learning (ages 5-7):

Use simple, visual language and pictorial posters for safety rules and evacuation routes.

Conduct short, focused evacuation drills with playful and reassuring elements to build familiarity and reduce fear.

Staff receive specialized training to guide young children calmly and effectively during drills.

Assign familiar staff or teachers as "safe adults," who will guide children and provide reassurance.

Primary School (ages 8-11):

Use age-appropriate language and diagrams in safety instructions.

Practice regular drills emphasizing quick, calm responses: “Drop, Cover, Hold” when inside, and orderly lining up outside.

Educate students about their safe zones, evacuation pathways, and the importance of not stopping for belongings.

Incorporate simple safety lessons into the curriculum for better understanding of earthquake procedures.

Secondary School (ages 12+):

Provide detailed safety briefings, emphasizing the importance of safety protocols and personal responsibility.

Regular drills simulate real scenarios, encouraging students to practice effective evacuation procedures independently.

Engage students in safety talks and encourage peer support during emergencies.

Conduct periodic assessments of students’ understanding of safety procedures.

4. Frequency, Execution, and Documentation

Two well-coordinated earthquake drills are held annually across the entire campus.

Prior to each drill, students and staff are notified with age-appropriate explanations to prepare them mentally and practically.

During drills, all students follow their designated safe zones or evacuation routes, guided by trained staff and teachers.

Teachers ensure electronics are unplugged, lights are turned off, and all students are accounted for before leaving their classrooms.

Students line up in a calm, organized manner outside, without rushing or stopping for belongings.

Staff supervise to ensure no one remains inside, and conduct headcounts to confirm attendance.

The entire evacuation process is timed and recorded for evaluation purposes.

After each drill, findings and improvements are documented, and a targeted action plan is implemented.

5. Supporting and Educating Students

The school organizes regular safety lessons tailored to each age group, using visual aids, stories, and age-appropriate language.

Visual safety signage and floor markings are installed throughout the campus, with clear symbols for evacuation routes and safe zones.

Teachers and staff foster a calm environment during drills, reassuring children and explaining what is happening in simple terms.

For children with special needs or temporary disabilities, designated staff offer personalized assistance during evacuations.

6. Post-Drill Review and Continuous Improvement

Safety teams review each drill’s effectiveness, focusing on age-specific responses and understanding.

Feedback from staff, students, and external safety consultants is gathered to enhance future drills.

Action plans are updated to address identified gaps, with ongoing staff training and curriculum integration.

Appendix A: EVACUATION REPORT

Type of exercise / emergency evacuation:

This document is to be used when conducting your termly fire drill / earthquake drill / lockdown exercise. The form should be completed by the Health & Safety Officer following the event and recorded in the Evacuation Log. The findings must be communicated to the Head of School and the SLT.

GENERAL INFORMATION

MAIN FINDINGS: include details of the exercise / what worked well / what areas require improvement, and immediate remedial action.

Date: Exercise Coordinator:

Head of School: